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MySQL NOT NULL Constraint

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MySQL NOT NULL Constraint

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The `NOT NULL` constraint enforces a column to NOT accept NULL values. This enforces a field to always contain a value, which means that you cannot insert a new record, or update a record without adding a value to this field.

By default, a column can hold NULL values.

NOT NULL on CREATE TABLE

To define a `NOT NULL` constraint when creating a table, add NOT NULL after the data type of the column name.

The following SQL creates a "Persons" table, and ensures that the "ID", "LastName", and "FirstName" columns cannot accept NULL values:

```
CREATE TABLE Persons (
    ID int NOT NULL,
    LastName varchar(255) NOT NULL,
    FirstName varchar(255) NOT NULL,
    Age int
);
```

NOT NULL on ALTER TABLE

To define a `NOT NULL` constraint on an existing table, use `ALTER TABLE` and add NOT NULL after the data type of the column name.

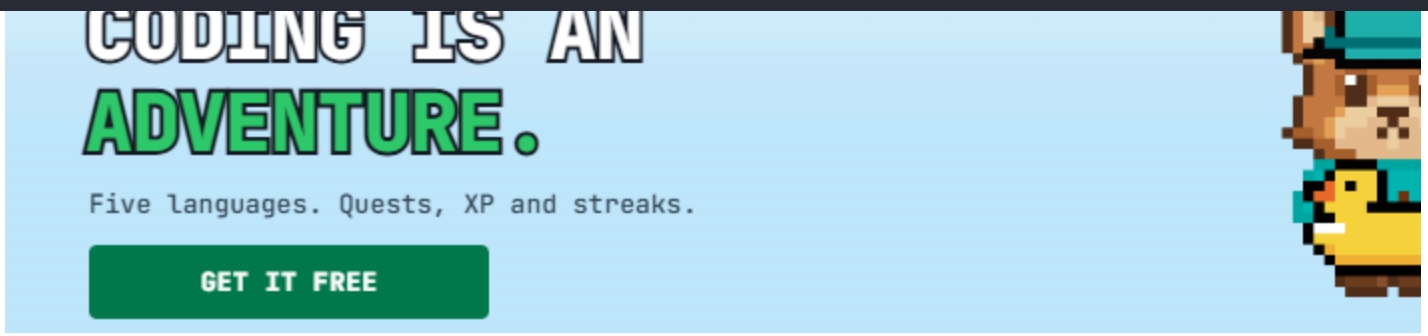
The following SQL adds a `NOT NULL` constraint on the "Age" column, after the "Persons" table is already created:

```
ALTER TABLE Persons
MODIFY Age int NOT NULL;
```

Remove a NOT NULL Constraint

To remove a `NOT NULL` constraint from a column (to let the column accept NULL values again), use the following syntax:

```
ALTER TABLE Persons
MODIFY Age int NULL;
```



REMOVE ADS

Exercise

What is the purpose of the SQL `NOT NULL` constraint?

- To ensure a column cannot have duplicate values
- To enforce that a column must always contain a value
- To define a unique identifier for a table
- To prevent a table from being dropped

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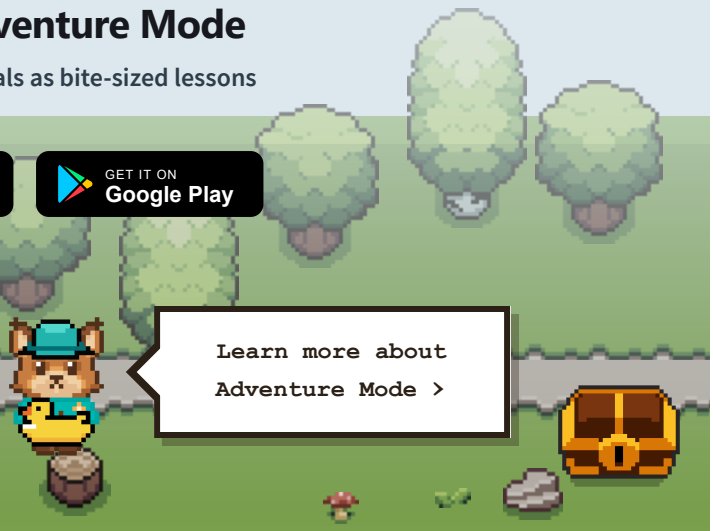
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